



Mobile medkit
Signostics medical has developed a market-ready, portable ultrasound device



HDMI for PMPS
The next generation of PMPS might sport a mobile variation of the HDMI port



xYz
Rumours are floating of a Xbox Zune hybrid portable gaming device from Microsoft



UDPMD

The Ultimate Digit Portable Multifunction Device: we take you through the design of the portable device of our dreams...

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On the 100th anniversary of the Ultimate Digit Portable Multifunction Device we bring you the initial draft of the gadget as taken from the archives at the Digit Library on Trantor.

Encyclopedia Digit > Year 3245 PA > The Ultimate Digit Portable Multifunction Device
“... when it was discovered that Digit's strict policy about “not spending 98% of your day fantasizing about cool devices” had been violated, the management decided to put the same to use. Thus the Ultimate Digit Portable Multifunction Device (UDPMD) was born.

After little deliberation the design was put to a test and became an instant success. Now having replaced almost every other portable device ever created...”

In the 21st century, the world has finally begun to shrink into our very pockets. Every aspect of our lives has now started to become available on the go. We have cellular phones to stay in touch with people, via voice and text, we have portable media players to keep us entertained, we have eBook readers to fit our entire library into

our pockets and we even have pocket PCs! The list is growing; the list is endless.

Amidst all this, a philosophical question begs asking: how many pockets can one have?

How many pockets?

Sometimes it seems that devices come intentionally crippled so that we need to buy more. Whether it be in form or function, some constraint or another forces

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us to go for another device, when one ought to have done the job.

This is why the UDPMD does everything. Or more precisely, can be made to do everything.

The reason computers have seeped into every field is because they are almost infinitely configurable. Whether it is playing your favorite games, or landing

the rover on Mars, the device in question always ends up being a computer. If you take into account every possible hardware accessory coupled with every software possible, computers can do virtually everything.

The UDPMD embraces the fact that every portable device is a computer, and opts to be fully expandable through hardware and software. It runs on open hardware, meaning that the core design of the system is not only known and published, but also unrestricted. It is however also standardized, so that modifications need to comply in order to be compatible.

Open hardware means that one has enough information to create any additions, modifications, and extensions for it, and doesn't need to pay anyone for the privilege. This steps above merely having an SDK to make applications for the device, as now you can write your own operating systems instead of relying on the one provided by the vendor. Open hardware also means that every manufacturer can manufacture it, without requiring a license, ensuring that customers can benefit best from the competition.